

Intel's workstation monster

Intel has readied a 10-core Westmere chip for use on servers

Bulldozer's beans to spill

AMD to unveil Bulldozer architecture soon, but they claim it's a new approach to multithreaded computing

Game peripheral test

With a plethora of features, some of which are useful to office users (like the side scroll), the G5 is a very good mouse and offers better precision and glide than the MX518 that has smaller feet. The price tag of Rs. 3,395 is surely not cheap, although experience tells it can be had for much lower on the street.

Logitech MX518

Is there any correct way to introduce a legend? If this isn't apt, please forgive, but some five years ago, the original MX518 changed the Indian gamers' perception of what a gaming mouse should be like. From a fraternity used to 400 dpi el-cheapo mice with tracking systems reminiscent of tortoises running on ice, we finally got, what was, back then, the holy grail of gaming – a useable, practical, accurate gaming mouse. The MX518 has paved the way for gaming mice in the country, and till today, it remains a competitive piece of gear, albeit overshadowing from some younger, better hardware-bearing competitors.

The surface is shiny, and from experience it wears well. The MX518 has a nice soft scroll wheel with a nice positive click. There's no side scroll, one of it's only glaring omissions. On account of this, the scroll wheel is slightly receded into the body of the mouse, whereas on the G5 it protrudes a bit more. The mouse buttons are comfortable.

The MX518 tracks very well on the Titan – accuracy is spot on. On the Destructor, we were expecting a mixed bag,

since the MX518 has very small feet. However, if anything, the MX518 glides with even less impedance than the G5 on the Destructor's surface. Accuracy goes up a notch too, since there is virtually no resistance to mouse movement, nor is it slippery enough to cause over tracking.

Priced at Rs. 1,795, and with market prices in the range of Rs. 1,300 or so, the MX518 is reasonably affordable for nearly anyone who has a decent computer. We'd call it "the gaming mouse of the masses" but even hardcore gamers will not be disappointed.



Logitech MX518

Steelseries Ikari

At first glance the Ikari is attractive and will grab attention due to its rather unique shape. The sides are muscular, the right side even more so, reminiscent of the wide wheel arches of the Bugatti Veyron. The sides are finished in matte, sweat resistant black and the top is a glossy steel grey. The mouse has a low profile, a welcome relief from Logitech's higher designs, although neither feels better or worse, and one can get accustomed to either.

In-hand feel is very good, the Ikari is comfortable, although for larger handed folk the body might seem a little small, owing to the lower profile, and parts of your palm and fingertips might trail on the mat

surface. The thumb recess is decent, not excessive. The brilliance however, lies on the other side. The huge bulge on the right is actually tailor-made for the ring finger and provides a comfortable expanse to rest it. Unlike the Logitech mice, where sometimes, the last finger touches the mousepad, there's smooth sailing here. The DPI toggle button is on the top and well located, and there is a backlit indicator to the two dpi toggles. Mousewheel click is positive, but feedback is absent. The mouse buttons have a positive click, but button travel is minimal – this isn't good or bad, just different – you just feel the click more on Logitech mice.

The Ikari tracks well on the Titan mat and is pretty accurate, but on the Destructor, we see a barely perceptible slower tracking, this causes a bit of under tracking, especially when fast tracking is desired, for example changing direction in a first person shooter game. At such times, one prefers the hairline greater accuracy of the G5 and other laser mice, we feel the surface of the destructor isn't very conducive to the infrared sensor on the Ikari, though strangely the MX518 had no such issues. If you're not into playing twitch-action games like *Quake III Arena*, you will hardly notice this issue. We didn't perceive a problem when playing *Warcraft 3*, that is a lot slower, but also has a lot of mouse movements and accuracy is important for moving



Steelseries Ikari

and selecting troops.

With an MRP of Rs. 2,999 the Ikari is clearly costlier than the MX518. It also feels better in-hand, and is more comfortable, and this coming from people used to Logitech mice is high praise indeed. If the thumb recess were a bit deeper, it'd be perfect, but for the price, you can get better hardware, for just a bit more.

Steelseries Kinzu

At first glance the Kinzu looks like what it is – a cheaper variant of the Ikari, aimed at the not-so-serious fragger. Although the shape isn't very ergonomic it's not uncomfortable, although we miss the finger caressing contours of the more upmarket mice. It's also terribly small, and only slightly larger than a medium sized notebook mouse – not something many gamers will like, although we wonder if female gamers find regular mice too large; in such cases this might be right up their alley. The entire top has a nice anti-slip grip. The mouse feels very solid, but this is also in part, due to its smaller size.

The DPI switch button is on the top, and looks identical to the Ikari, but there's no indicator. The mouse wheel is a simple, plastic affair, but its action is solid and the click is pretty positive. The left and right click on the mouse is better than the Ikari – more feedback and travel. The cable on the Kinzu is a lot thinner than the Ikari – as expected.

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